

Question:

A 29-year-old man presents to his primary care provider complaining of testicular pain. He reports a four-day history of dull chronic pain in his left testicle that is worse with standing. His past medical history is notable for asthma and major depressive disorder. He takes inhaled albuterol as needed and sertraline. He is sexually active with a single female partner and always uses barrier protection. His temperature is 99.2°F (37.3°C), blood pressure is 125/75 mmHg, pulse is 85/min, and respirations are 17/min. Physical examination reveals a non-tender twisted mass along the left spermatic cord that disappears when the patient lies supine. This patient’s condition most likely stems from decreased laminar flow at which of the following vascular junctions?

Answer Choices:

- A. Left testicular vein – Left renal vein
- B. Left testicular vein – Inferior vena cava
- C. Descending aorta – Left testicular artery
- D. Left testicular vein – Left internal iliac vein

Reasoning + Answer:

<think> The patient's symptoms of dull chronic pain in the left testicle that worsens with standing and disappears when lying supine are indicative of a condition where there is increased pressure or pooling of blood in the testicle , which is commonly seen in a varicocele where the veins of the testicle become enlarged and twisted , similar to how a twisted mass would be felt and is relieved by lying down as the blood pools in the veins when standing , which can cause increased pressure at the junction of the left testicular vein and the inferior vena cava as they join together.</think>

<answer> B . Left testicular vein âĖĴ Inferior vena cava </answer>

